

PROJECT 5 – HOME CYBER SECURITY CHECKLIST

1. Introduction

Cybersecurity is important for protecting personal devices, accounts, files, and network connections from common security threats. This project was performed to assess the basic security configuration of a Windows laptop and identify whether important security protections were enabled.

The checklist covered antivirus protection, firewall, automatic updates, password security, screen locking, backups, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), browser updates, Wi-Fi password security, and device encryption.

2. Objective

The objective of this project is to assess the basic security of a home computer or laptop and recommend improvements based on cybersecurity best practices.

3. Tools and Environment

- Windows Laptop
- Windows Security
- Windows Settings
- Google Chrome
- Google Account Security
- Internet/Wi-Fi connection

4. Security Checklist Results

S.No.	Security Check	Status
1	Antivirus installed and updated	✓ Enabled
2	Firewall enabled	✓ Enabled
3	Automatic Updates enabled	✓ Enabled

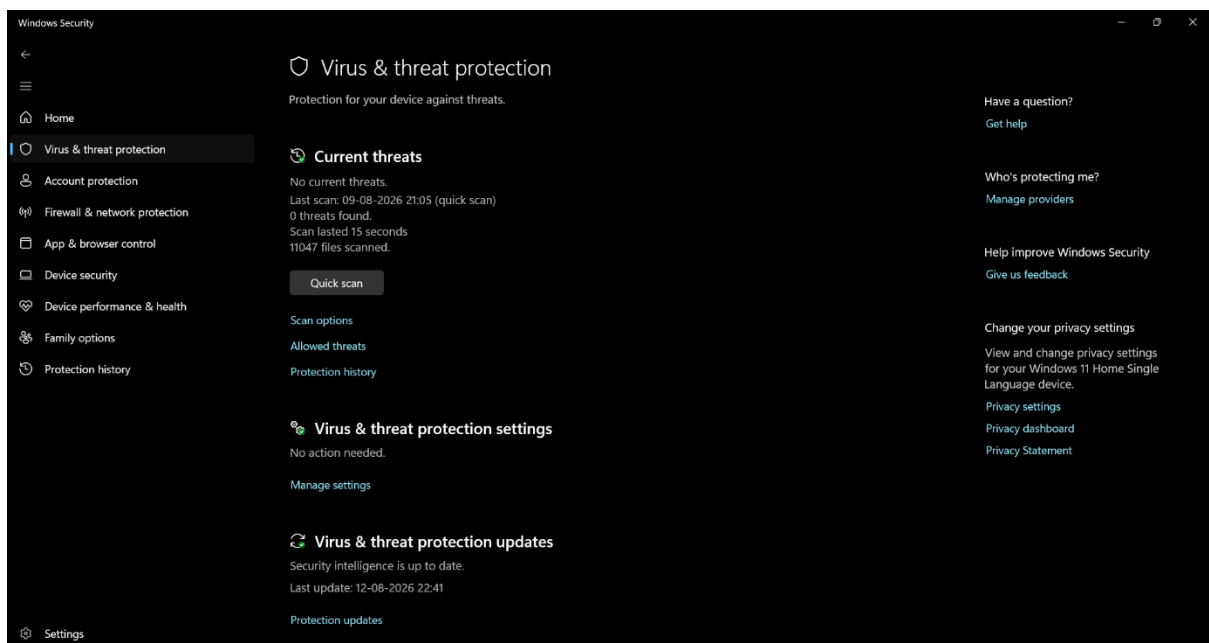
4	Strong device password	✓ Enabled
5	Screen Lock enabled	✓ Enabled
6	Backups configured	✓ Enabled
7	Multi-Factor Authentication enabled	✓ Enabled
8	Web browser up to date	✓ Enabled
9	Wi-Fi password is strong	✓ Enabled
10	Device encryption enabled	✓ Enabled

5. Task 1 – Antivirus Protection

Windows Security was opened and the Virus & threat protection section was checked.

The system showed **No current threats**. The last scan found **0 threats** after scanning **11,047 files**. The security intelligence was also shown as **up to date**, with the latest update on **12-08-2026**.

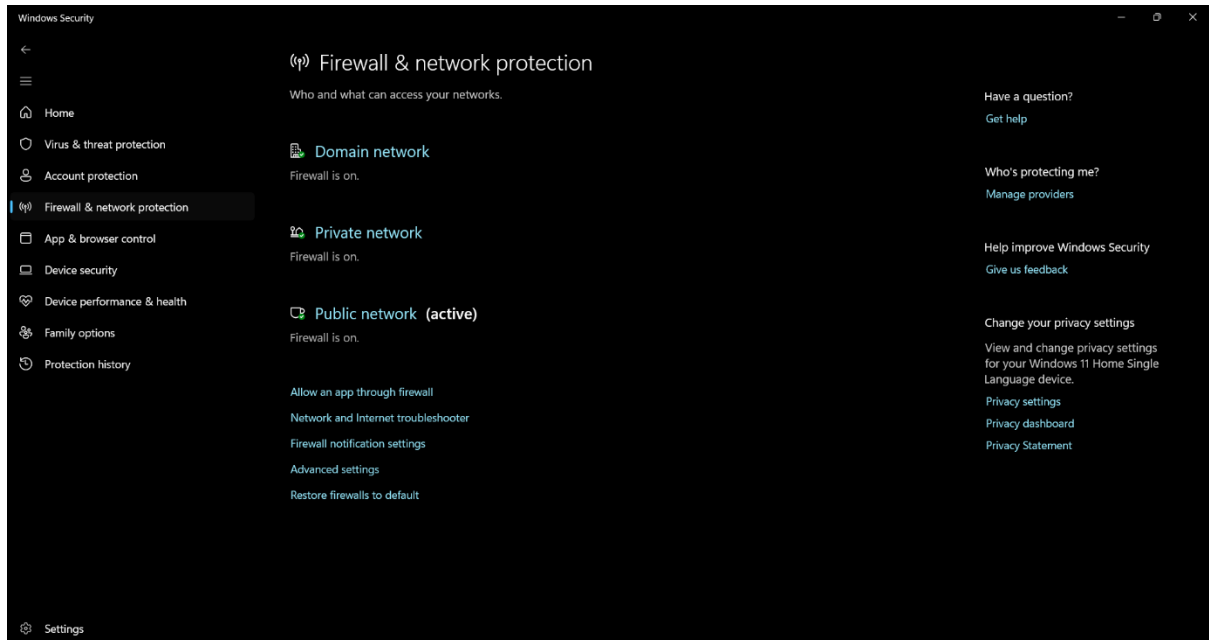
Result: ✓ Enabled



6. Task 2 – Firewall

The Firewall & network protection settings were checked in Windows Security. The firewall was shown as **On**, indicating that the system firewall was enabled.

Result: ✓ Enabled

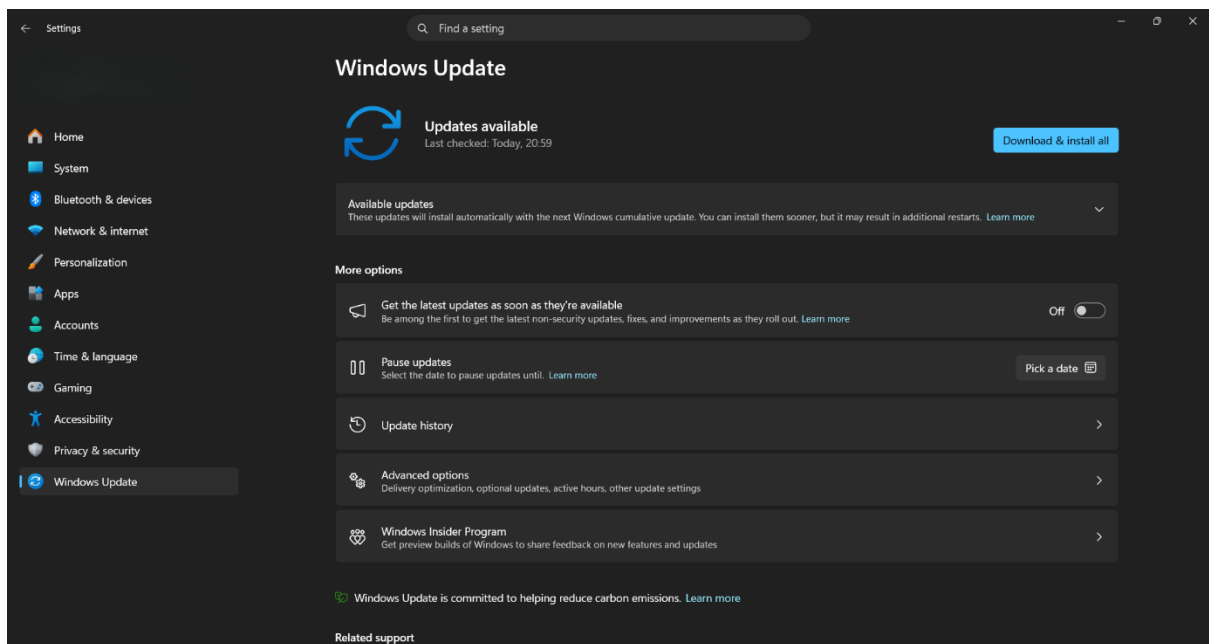


7. Task 3 – Automatic Updates

The Windows Update settings were checked. The system showed that updates were available to download and also indicated that the updates would complete automatically.

This confirms that automatic updating was enabled.

Result: ✓ Enabled

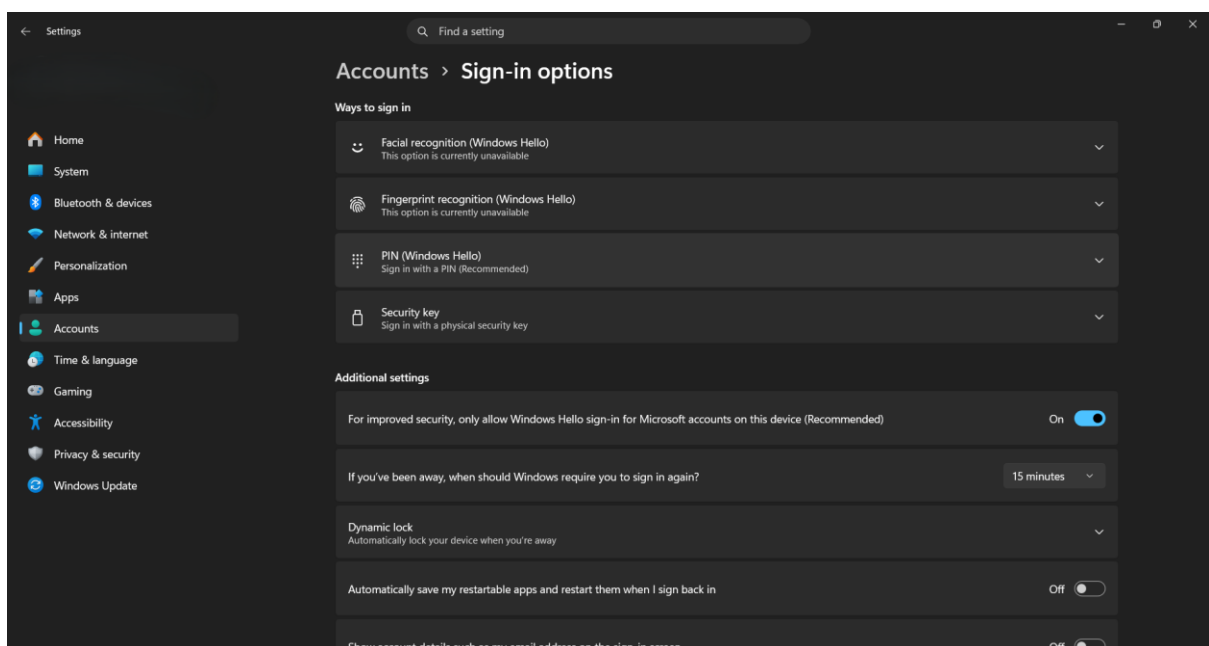


8. Task 4 – Strong Password

The Sign-in options in Windows Settings were checked. Windows Hello PIN sign-in was configured on the device. The device password was also checked separately and confirmed to follow strong-password practices.

A strong password should be difficult to guess and should avoid easily identifiable personal information.

Result: ✓ Enabled

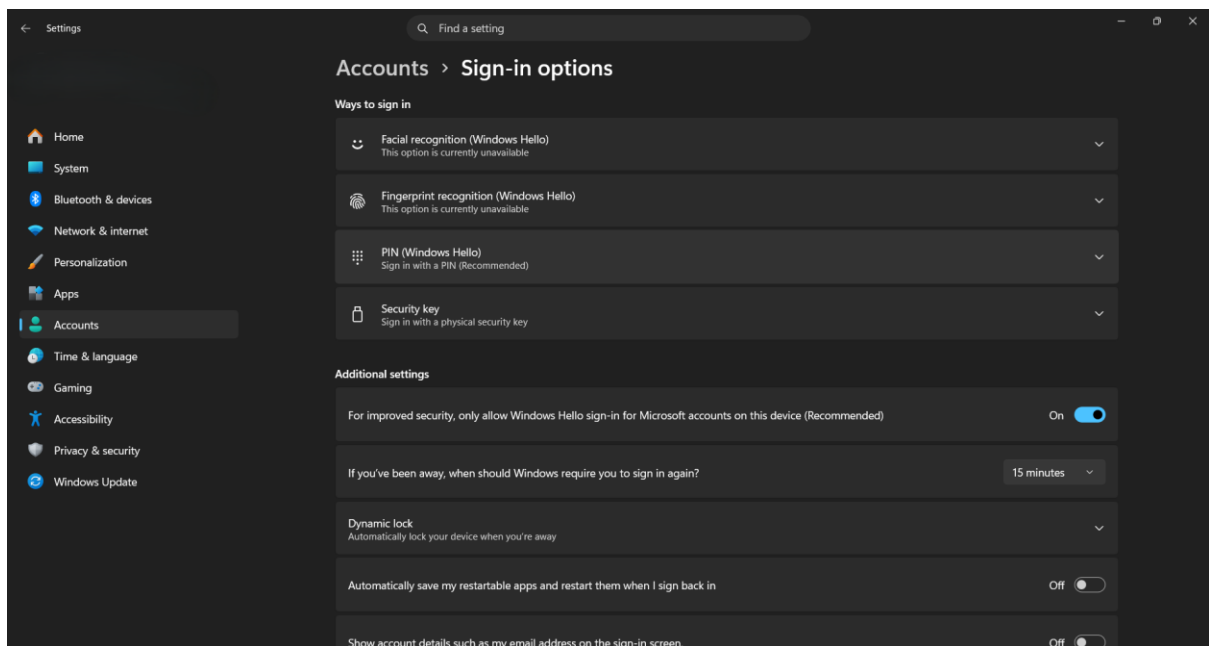


9. Task 5 – Screen Lock

The Sign-in options were checked to verify the screen-lock requirement. The system was configured to require sign-in again after a period of inactivity.

The device was set to require sign-in after **15 minutes** of being away.

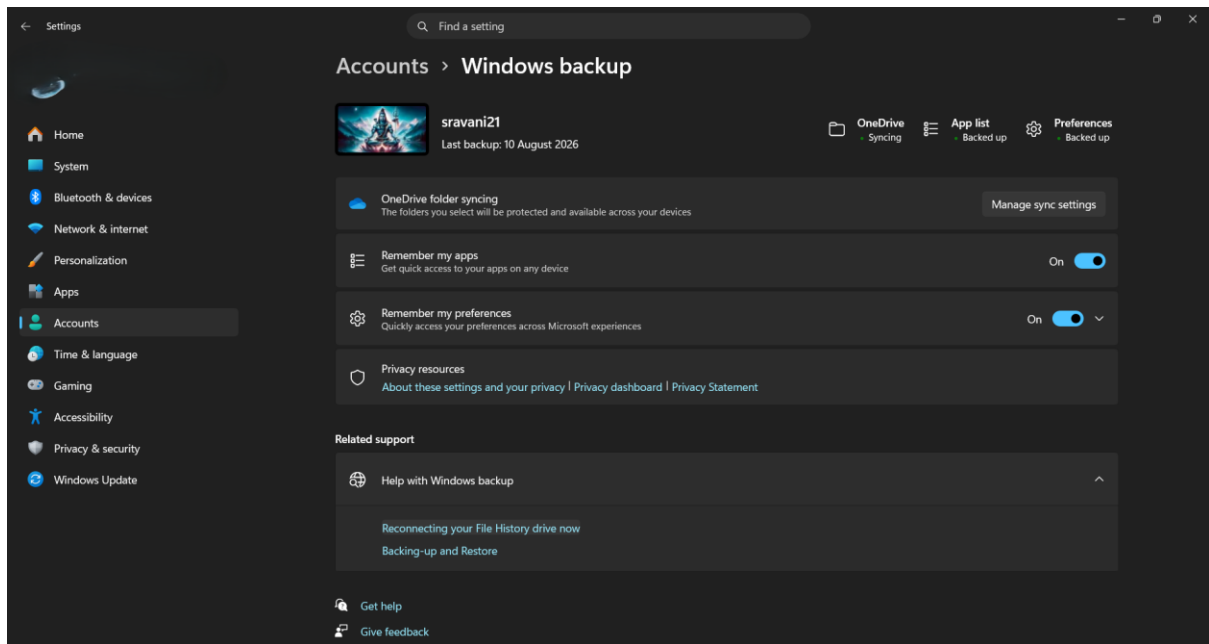
Result: ✓ Enabled



10. Task 6 – Backups

The Windows Backup settings were checked. The system showed that the **last backup was performed on 10-Aug-2026**, indicating that backups were configured.

Result: ✓ Enabled

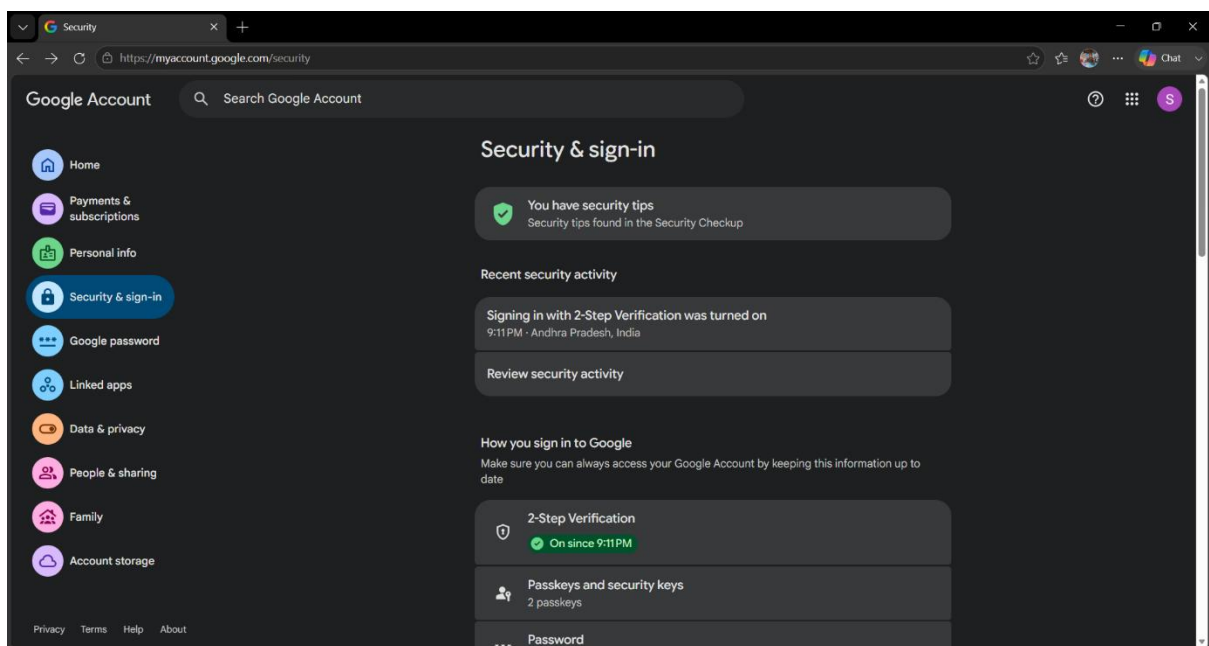


11. Task 7 – Multi-Factor Authentication

Multi-Factor Authentication was checked for an important Google account. The Google Account Security settings showed that **2-Step Verification was turned On**.

This provides an additional layer of protection beyond the account password.

Result: ✓ Enabled

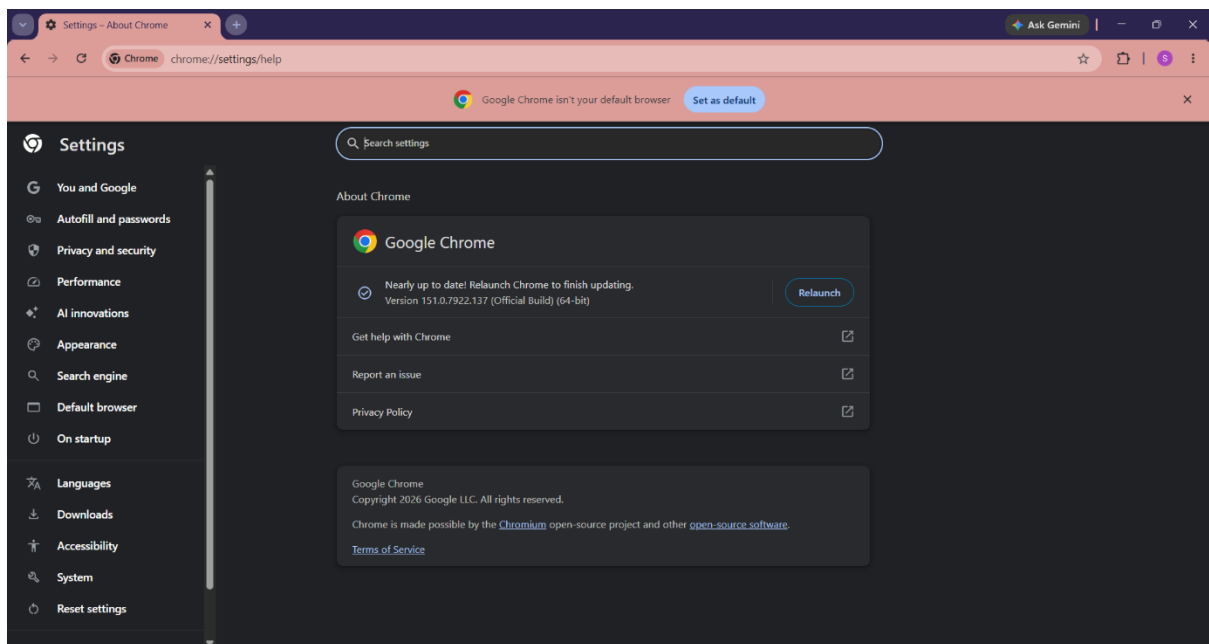


12. Task 8 – Web Browser Update

Google Chrome was checked using the **Help → About Google Chrome** section. Chrome reported that it was **up to date**.

Keeping the browser updated helps ensure that the latest security fixes are available.

Result: ✓ Enabled

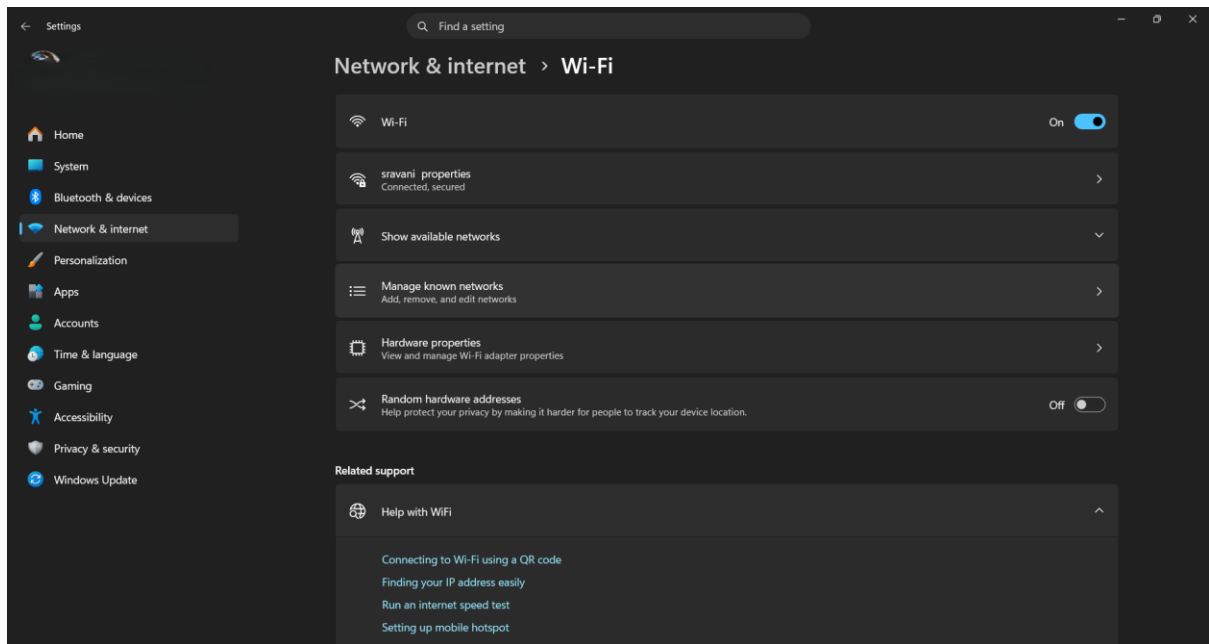


13. Task 9 – Wi-Fi Password Security

The Wi-Fi settings were checked and the connected Wi-Fi network was verified. The Wi-Fi password was also reviewed without exposing the actual password.

The password follows strong-password practices and is not based on easily guessable information.

Result: ✓ Enabled

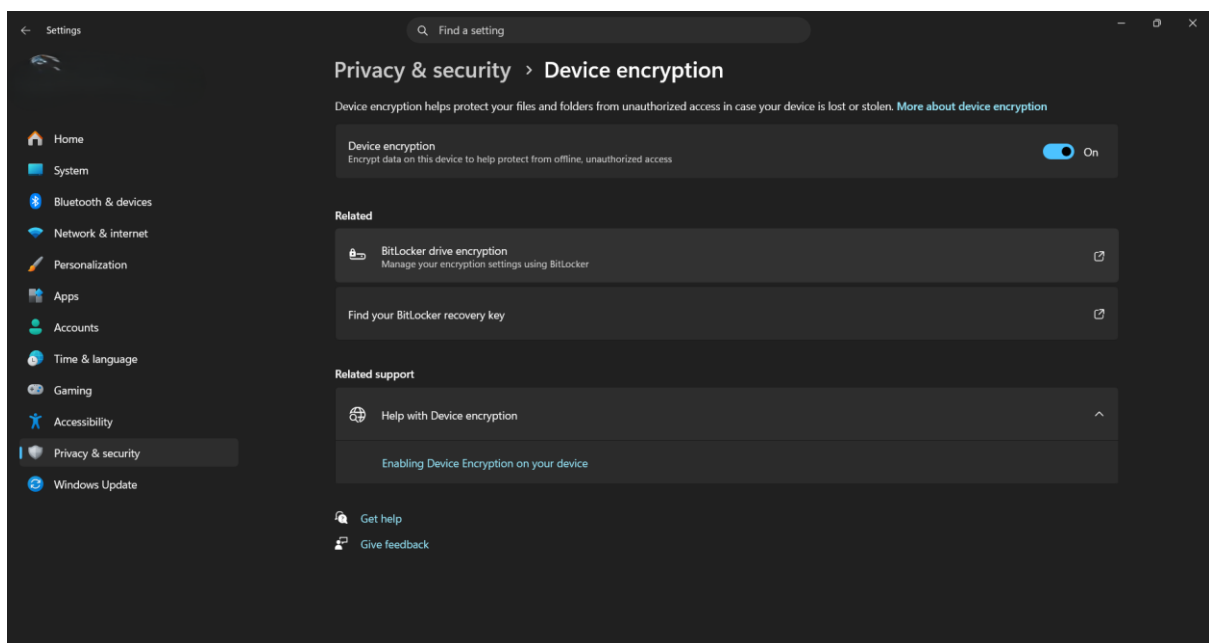


14. Task 10 – Device Encryption

The Device Encryption settings were checked in Windows Settings. Device encryption was shown as **On**, confirming that encryption was enabled on the device.

Encryption helps protect stored data if the device is lost or accessed without authorization.

Result: ✓ Enabled



15. Recommendations

Based on the security checklist, the following recommendations can further improve the security of the device and home network:

1. **Keep Windows and installed applications updated:** Regular updates should be installed to receive important security fixes.
2. **Use unique and strong passwords:** Different strong passwords should be used for important accounts to reduce the impact of password compromise.
3. **Enable MFA on important accounts:** Multi-Factor Authentication should be enabled wherever it is available, especially for email, banking, cloud storage, and social media accounts.
4. **Maintain regular backups:** Important personal and academic files should be backed up regularly so that they can be recovered in case of accidental deletion, hardware failure, or malware.
5. **Keep antivirus and firewall protection enabled:** Windows Security protections should remain active and should not be disabled unnecessarily.
6. **Secure the home Wi-Fi network:** A strong Wi-Fi password should be used, and the router firmware should be kept updated.
7. **Use device encryption:** Encryption should remain enabled to protect personal data stored on the laptop.
8. **Avoid suspicious links and downloads:** Unknown email attachments, suspicious websites, and untrusted software should be avoided to reduce the risk of malware and phishing attacks.

16. Conclusion

The Home Cyber Security Checklist was completed by checking the main security features of the Windows laptop. Antivirus protection, firewall, automatic updates, password security, screen lock, backups, MFA, browser updates, Wi-Fi security, and device encryption were verified.

All ten checklist items were found to be enabled or configured. The assessment also highlighted several good cybersecurity practices that can be continued to maintain the security of the device and home network.

This project helped in understanding basic cyber hygiene, identifying common security protections, and applying practical security measures to a personal computing environment.

17. Evidence Summary

The following screenshots should be included as evidence in the report:

- **Task 1:** Antivirus / Virus & threat protection
- **Task 2:** Firewall is On
- **Task 3:** Windows Update status
- **Task 4:** Sign-in options / Windows Hello
- **Task 5:** Use Task 4 screenshot showing screen-lock setting
- **Task 6:** Windows Backup – Last backup
- **Task 7:** Google 2-Step Verification
- **Task 8:** Chrome – Up to date
- **Task 9:** Wi-Fi settings without exposing password
- **Task 10:** Device Encryption – On